

DESIGN THINKING: A PRIMER

Multiple Choice Question Paper

Total Questions: 100	Total Marks: 100
Time Allowed: 2 Hours	Each Question: 1 Mark

Instructions: Each question carries one mark. Choose the single best answer (A, B, C or D) for each question. There is no negative marking. An answer key is provided at the end of the paper.

- Design Thinking is best described as a:
 - Purely technical engineering discipline
 - Human-centred approach to innovation and problem solving
 - Financial accounting technique
 - Random trial-and-error method
- Which organisation is most closely associated with popularising Design Thinking?
 - OPEC
 - WHO
 - NASA
 - IDEO
- Who is the author often credited with bringing Design Thinking to business through IDEO?
 - Tim Brown
 - Peter Drucker
 - Bill Gates
 - Steve Jobs
- The d.school that teaches Design Thinking is part of which university?
 - Harvard
 - Stanford
 - MIT
 - Oxford
- At the core of Design Thinking is empathy for the:
 - Investor
 - End user / customer
 - Government
 - Competitor
- The classic five-stage Design Thinking model begins with which stage?
 - Empathize
 - Test
 - Prototype
 - Ideate
- Which is the correct order of the five stages of Design Thinking?
 - Ideate, Empathize, Define, Test, Prototype
 - Empathize, Define, Ideate, Prototype, Test
 - Define, Empathize, Ideate, Test, Prototype
 - Prototype, Test, Ideate, Define, Empathize
- The three overlapping lenses of Design Thinking are desirability, feasibility, and:
 - Viability
 - Variability
 - Visibility

(D) Volatility

9. 'Desirability' in Design Thinking primarily refers to what is:

- (A) Technically possible
- (B) Meaningful and useful to people
- (C) Financially sustainable
- (D) Legally permitted

10. 'Feasibility' refers to what is:

- (A) Profitable
- (B) Aesthetically pleasing
- (C) Desirable to users
- (D) Technically and organisationally possible

11. 'Viability' refers to what is:

- (A) Financially and strategically sustainable
- (B) Emotionally appealing
- (C) Easy to prototype
- (D) Technically possible

12. The main goal of the Empathize stage is to:

- (A) Write marketing copy
- (B) Calculate the budget
- (C) Understand users' needs, emotions and motivations
- (D) Build the final product

13. Which is a primary method used during the Empathize stage?

- (A) Patent filing
- (B) User observation and interviews
- (C) Mass production
- (D) Stock analysis

14. An 'empathy map' typically captures what the user says, thinks, does and:

- (A) Sells
- (B) Owns
- (C) Feels
- (D) Buys

15. A fictional character representing a user segment is called a:

- (A) Avatar bot
- (B) Persona
- (C) Prototype
- (D) Stakeholder

16. A customer journey map is used to visualise the user's:

- (A) Tax records
- (B) Bank balance
- (C) Genetic profile
- (D) Experience and touchpoints over time

17. The Define stage is mainly about:

- (A) Framing a clear, actionable problem statement
- (B) Selling the product
- (C) Mass manufacturing
- (D) Generating many ideas

18. A well-framed problem statement in Design Thinking is also known as a:

- (A) Point of View (POV) statement

- (B) Press release
- (C) Mission statement
- (D) Profit statement

19. Which phrase is commonly used to reframe problems as opportunities for ideation?

- (A) When Could They
- (B) Why Not Now
- (C) How Might We
- (D) What If Only

20. A good problem statement should be:

- (A) Broad and vague
- (B) Human-centred and not prescribe a solution
- (C) Focused only on technology
- (D) About the company's revenue

21. The Ideate stage focuses on:

- (A) Narrowing to one idea immediately
- (B) Testing prototypes
- (C) Conducting interviews
- (D) Generating a large quantity of diverse ideas

22. Brainstorming works best when participants initially aim for:

- (A) Quality over quantity
- (B) Criticism of every idea
- (C) Silence
- (D) Quantity of ideas and deferred judgment

23. A key rule of brainstorming is to:

- (A) Defer judgment and build on others' ideas
- (B) Stop at one idea
- (C) Allow only the manager to speak
- (D) Judge ideas immediately

24. 'Going for quantity' during ideation helps because:

- (A) It impresses investors
- (B) It reduces the need for testing
- (C) More ideas guarantee lower cost
- (D) A larger pool increases chances of novel solutions

25. SCAMPER is a technique used for:

- (A) User testing
- (B) Budgeting
- (C) Stimulating creative ideas
- (D) Market sizing

26. In SCAMPER, the 'S' commonly stands for:

- (A) Substitute
- (B) Standardise
- (C) Sell
- (D) Simplify

27. The 'C' in SCAMPER stands for:

- (A) Calculate
- (B) Compete
- (C) Combine
- (D) Copy

- 28.** Mind mapping is primarily a tool for:
- (A) Organising and generating ideas visually
 - (B) Inventory control
 - (C) Financial forecasting
 - (D) Code compilation
- 29.** Divergent thinking is about:
- (A) Following strict rules
 - (B) Expanding and generating many possibilities
 - (C) Selecting the single best option
 - (D) Cutting costs
- 30.** Convergent thinking is about:
- (A) Generating endless options
 - (B) Narrowing down and selecting the best ideas
 - (C) Avoiding decisions
 - (D) Ignoring constraints
- 31.** The Prototype stage aims to:
- (A) Conduct payroll
 - (B) Finalise mass production
 - (C) Replace the testing stage
 - (D) Build quick, inexpensive representations of ideas to learn
- 32.** A 'low-fidelity' prototype is typically:
- (A) A fully functional product
 - (B) A legal contract
 - (C) A finished mobile app
 - (D) Rough and inexpensive, like a paper sketch
- 33.** The main purpose of prototyping is to:
- (A) Impress shareholders
 - (B) Learn quickly and fail cheaply
 - (C) Avoid talking to users
 - (D) Skip the testing phase
- 34.** The Test stage is used to:
- (A) Gather user feedback and refine the solution
 - (B) Stop the project
 - (C) Launch the final product to the entire market
 - (D) Fire underperforming staff
- 35.** Design Thinking is generally considered a process that is:
- (A) Iterative and non-linear
 - (B) Done only once
 - (C) Strictly linear and one-directional
 - (D) Independent of users
- 36.** 'Iteration' in Design Thinking means:
- (A) Repeating and refining steps based on learning
 - (B) Avoiding feedback
 - (C) Copying competitors
 - (D) Doing the project once perfectly
- 37.** The Double Diamond model was popularised by the:
- (A) United Nations
 - (B) British Design Council

- (C) World Bank
- (D) Stanford d.school

38. The Double Diamond model alternates between divergent and ____ thinking.

- (A) random
- (B) negative
- (C) convergent
- (D) linear

39. The first diamond of the Double Diamond focuses on:

- (A) Finding the right problem
- (B) Building the solution
- (C) Manufacturing
- (D) Marketing

40. The second diamond of the Double Diamond focuses on:

- (A) Filing patents
- (B) Developing and delivering the right solution
- (C) Hiring staff
- (D) Defining the problem

41. 'Human-centred design' places which group at the centre of the process?

- (A) Regulators
- (B) People who will use the solution
- (C) Shareholders
- (D) Suppliers

42. Which mindset is essential to Design Thinking?

- (A) Avoiding users
- (B) Bias towards action and experimentation
- (C) Fear of failure
- (D) Working in isolation

43. A 'bias towards action' encourages designers to:

- (A) Delay decisions indefinitely
- (B) Make and test ideas rather than only discuss them
- (C) Avoid prototypes
- (D) Plan endlessly without acting

44. Storytelling in Design Thinking is used to:

- (A) Hide failures
- (B) Confuse stakeholders
- (C) Replace research
- (D) Communicate insights and ideas persuasively

45. Reframing a problem helps a team to:

- (A) See the challenge from new perspectives
- (B) Lock into the first solution
- (C) Reduce empathy
- (D) Avoid creativity

46. 'Beginner's mind' (or beginner's mindset) encourages designers to:

- (A) Ignore the user
- (B) Assume they know everything
- (C) Rely only on experts
- (D) Approach problems with curiosity and without assumptions

47. Observing users in their natural environment is sometimes called:

- (A) Auditing
- (B) Cold calling
- (C) Mass surveying only
- (D) Contextual inquiry / ethnographic observation

48. Open-ended interview questions are preferred because they:

- (A) Encourage rich, detailed responses
- (B) Save the most money
- (C) Yield yes/no answers
- (D) Avoid talking to users

49. A 'leading question' in user research should generally be:

- (A) Used to sell products
- (B) Encouraged
- (C) Avoided because it biases answers
- (D) Used to confuse users

50. Latent needs are needs that users:

- (A) Have but may not be able to articulate
- (B) Never actually have
- (C) Only mention in surveys
- (D) State clearly and loudly

51. Synthesis in Design Thinking refers to:

- (A) Ignoring data
- (B) Making sense of research to find patterns and insights
- (C) Selling the product
- (D) Building the product

52. An 'insight' is best described as a:

- (A) Non-obvious realisation that guides design
- (B) Random guess
- (C) Sales figure
- (D) Raw data point

53. Affinity mapping (clustering sticky notes) is used to:

- (A) Calculate profit
- (B) Recruit staff
- (C) Test prototypes
- (D) Group related observations to reveal themes

54. 'Fail fast, fail cheap' encourages teams to:

- (A) Avoid all risk
- (B) Never prototype
- (C) Hide mistakes
- (D) Learn early from inexpensive experiments

55. Which of the following is NOT one of the five classic stages?

- (A) Test
- (B) Empathize
- (C) Monetize
- (D) Define

56. A storyboard in Design Thinking is used to:

- (A) Record finances
- (B) List employees
- (C) Visualise a user's experience as a sequence of frames

(D) Replace prototyping entirely

57. Role-playing and bodystorming are techniques used to:

- (A) Audit accounts
- (B) Physically act out and empathise with experiences
- (C) Write code
- (D) Calculate taxes

58. 'Wizard of Oz' prototyping involves:

- (A) Humans simulating system functions behind the scenes
- (B) No users at all
- (C) Final production
- (D) A fully automated system

59. The primary benefit of testing with real users is to:

- (A) Increase development cost
- (B) Avoid iteration
- (C) Uncover flaws and gather actionable feedback
- (D) Confirm the team is always right

60. In Design Thinking, failure is viewed as:

- (A) Irrelevant
- (B) A reason to quit
- (C) Always unacceptable
- (D) A valuable source of learning

61. Multidisciplinary teams are valued in Design Thinking because they:

- (A) Bring varied perspectives and richer solutions
- (B) Slow everything down needlessly
- (C) Avoid collaboration
- (D) Reduce diversity of thought

62. Co-creation means involving _____ in the design process.

- (A) only engineers
- (B) only designers
- (C) only executives
- (D) users and stakeholders

63. 'How Might We' statements are deliberately phrased to be:

- (A) Optimistic and open to many solutions
- (B) Purely technical
- (C) Narrow and prescriptive
- (D) Negative

64. A prototype that looks and works close to the final product is called:

- (A) Low-fidelity
- (B) High-fidelity
- (C) Verbal
- (D) Paper-only

65. Rapid prototyping emphasises:

- (A) High upfront cost
- (B) Perfection before showing anyone
- (C) Avoiding users
- (D) Speed and quick feedback cycles

66. In ideation, 'building on the ideas of others' is captured by the phrase:

- (A) 'Maybe later'

- (B) 'Yes, and'
- (C) 'No, but'
- (D) 'Not now'

67. The phrase 'Yes, and' encourages participants to:

- (A) Accept and expand on contributions
- (B) Stay silent
- (C) Reject ideas
- (D) Compete

68. A key reason to defer judgment during ideation is to:

- (A) Avoid prototyping
- (B) Create psychological safety for wild ideas
- (C) Speed up firing
- (D) Reduce the number of ideas

69. Visualisation (sketching) in Design Thinking helps to:

- (A) Hide ideas
- (B) Increase confusion
- (C) Make abstract ideas tangible and shareable
- (D) Replace user research

70. Which factor does Design Thinking balance alongside human needs?

- (A) Technology and business viability
- (B) Only profit
- (C) Only aesthetics
- (D) Only regulations

71. The Empathize and Define stages together are often called the ____ space.

- (A) delivery
- (B) problem
- (C) production
- (D) solution

72. The Ideate, Prototype and Test stages are often called the ____ space.

- (A) solution
- (B) audit
- (C) problem
- (D) research

73. 'Point of View' (POV) typically combines a user, a need, and an:

- (A) Advertisement
- (B) Algorithm
- (C) Invoice
- (D) Insight

74. Which is a common pitfall in problem definition?

- (A) Keeping it human-centred
- (B) Framing it around the user
- (C) Being specific
- (D) Embedding a solution inside the problem statement

75. Prototyping helps reduce:

- (A) Empathy
- (B) User involvement
- (C) Risk and uncertainty before full investment
- (D) Creativity

76. The concept of 'wicked problems' refers to problems that are:

- (A) Already solved
- (B) Purely mathematical
- (C) Complex, ill-defined and interconnected
- (D) Simple and well-defined

77. Design Thinking is especially useful for tackling problems that are:

- (A) Ambiguous and human-centred
- (B) Purely numerical
- (C) Already fully understood
- (D) Routine and obvious

78. A 'value proposition' describes:

- (A) The benefit a solution offers to users
- (B) The office location
- (C) The number of employees
- (D) The company's tax rate

79. Empathy interviews should ideally make the interviewee feel:

- (A) Judged
- (B) Pressured to buy
- (C) Comfortable and free to share
- (D) Confused

80. The 'Five Whys' technique is used to:

- (A) Avoid analysis
- (B) Increase sales
- (C) Generate prototypes
- (D) Dig down to the root cause of a problem

81. Asking 'why' repeatedly during research helps uncover:

- (A) Financial reports
- (B) Surface-level facts only
- (C) Competitor pricing
- (D) Underlying motivations and root causes

82. A 'minimum viable product' (MVP) is built to:

- (A) Include every possible feature
- (B) Avoid user feedback
- (C) Test core assumptions with minimal effort
- (D) Maximise initial cost

83. In Design Thinking, constraints are viewed as:

- (A) Only obstacles
- (B) Reasons to stop
- (C) Drivers that can spark creativity
- (D) Irrelevant

84. The term 'ideation' is most closely linked to which stage?

- (A) Ideate
- (B) Test
- (C) Empathize
- (D) Define

85. Which is a divergent activity?

- (A) Final voting
- (B) Cutting the idea list

- (C) Selecting the final concept
- (D) Brainstorming many ideas

86. Which is a convergent activity?

- (A) Dot-voting to prioritise ideas
- (B) Generating variations
- (C) Brainstorming wildly
- (D) Free association

87. 'Dot voting' is a technique to:

- (A) Quickly prioritise options as a group
- (B) Generate ideas
- (C) Interview users
- (D) Build prototypes

88. Tim Brown describes Design Thinking as drawing on the designer's:

- (A) Sensibility and methods to match needs with feasibility
- (B) Sales quotas
- (C) Legal training
- (D) Accounting skills

89. Which of these best reflects a Design Thinking mindset?

- (A) Work alone in secret
- (B) Avoid feedback
- (C) Assume the solution first
- (D) Embrace ambiguity and stay curious

90. Prototyping 'to think' means using prototypes to:

- (A) Replace strategy
- (B) Avoid decisions
- (C) Skip empathy
- (D) Explore and refine ideas, not just demonstrate them

91. Which tool helps capture the emotional highs and lows of a user experience?

- (A) Gantt chart only
- (B) Balance sheet
- (C) Org chart
- (D) Journey map with an emotional curve

92. Reframing 'people don't use the stairs' as 'how might we make stairs fun' is an example of:

- (A) Convergent thinking
- (B) Cost cutting
- (C) Opportunity-focused problem reframing
- (D) Ignoring the user

93. Brainstorming sessions benefit from a clear:

- (A) Single approved idea
- (B) Focus question or 'How Might We' prompt
- (C) Ban on speaking
- (D) List of criticisms

94. In Design Thinking, the user's needs are discovered mainly through:

- (A) Assumptions
- (B) Random guessing
- (C) Sales targets
- (D) Empathy and research

95. Which is the best example of a high-fidelity prototype?

- (A) A napkin sketch
- (B) A single sticky note
- (C) A verbal description
- (D) An interactive clickable app mock-up

96. The overall spirit of Design Thinking can be summarised as:

- (A) Isolated and theoretical
- (B) Solution-first and rigid
- (C) Human-centred, collaborative and experimental
- (D) Profit-only and fixed

97. Prototyping and testing together help teams to:

- (A) Eliminate users
- (B) Skip empathy
- (C) Validate or invalidate assumptions before scaling
- (D) Avoid learning

98. A core question the Empathize stage tries to answer is:

- (A) What do users truly need and feel
- (B) Which competitor to copy
- (C) Who should we fire
- (D) How much profit will we make

99. Design Thinking is sometimes described as a balance of analytical thinking and:

- (A) Strict bureaucracy
- (B) Intuitive (creative) thinking
- (C) Random guessing
- (D) Financial auditing

100. Which deliverable best summarises the Define stage?

- (A) A marketing budget
- (B) A clear, actionable problem statement
- (C) A staffing plan
- (D) A finished product

ANSWER KEY

1. B	2. D	3. A	4. B	5. B
6. A	7. B	8. A	9. B	10. D
11. A	12. C	13. B	14. C	15. B
16. D	17. A	18. A	19. C	20. B
21. D	22. D	23. A	24. D	25. C
26. A	27. C	28. A	29. B	30. B
31. D	32. D	33. B	34. A	35. A
36. A	37. B	38. C	39. A	40. B
41. B	42. B	43. B	44. D	45. A
46. D	47. D	48. A	49. C	50. A
51. B	52. A	53. D	54. D	55. C
56. C	57. B	58. A	59. C	60. D
61. A	62. D	63. A	64. B	65. D
66. B	67. A	68. B	69. C	70. A
71. B	72. A	73. D	74. D	75. C
76. C	77. A	78. A	79. C	80. D
81. D	82. C	83. C	84. A	85. D
86. A	87. A	88. A	89. D	90. D
91. D	92. C	93. B	94. D	95. D
96. C	97. C	98. A	99. B	100. B